

31 In the lungs, movement of dissolved carbon dioxide out of the capillaries occurs in one of two ways:

- by diffusion through the endothelial cells of the capillaries
- by leakage through pores in the endothelial cells of the capillaries.

What is the **minimum** number of times that a carbon dioxide molecule that has been transported to the lungs in a red blood cell must cross a cell surface membrane to reach an air space in an alveolus?

A 2

B 3

C 4

D 5